

AMD

AMD's APU is slightly better when compared to Intel since AMD uses technology from its graphics division. This way they have tried and tested technology to rely on which means less R&D is needed. The current HD8670D which is present in the A10-6800K APU outshines all current generation AMD APUs and Intel HD graphics.

What to buy

While shopping for a processor keep the following points in mind

1. Figure out your needs and your usage scenario. This means all the types of applications that you are going to be using. Certain applications need all the processing power that a quad core processor with hyper-threading can provide.
2. The motherboard and CPU go hand in hand, gone are the days when one could just upgrade either, nowadays sockets and processors are phased out so fast that if you wish to upgrade one then the other is absolutely necessary.
3. Chipsets determine the capabilities of a processor that can be used, higher end chipsets support overclocking and are part of much expensive boards.
4. If you are going to overclock your processor then remember to get a better cooler and thermal paste. If you are an enthusiast then you know what needs to be done.
5. Integrated graphics are only good for old games, so don't rely on a high-end processor to deliver stunning graphics. You need a discrete graphics card for that.
6. For scenarios where a lot of parallel processing needs to be done, look at graphics cards and software optimised to use CUDA / stream processors. 